

VIVA

Every assessment should be capable of explanation and defence.

VIVA is proposed practical language for applying Oxford's principles on AI use in summative assessment. It is not a replacement for University policy or local approval processes.

V Valid

The task tests what it is meant to test.

Start from the purpose of the assessment, tell students what it is, and choose the AI permission level that protects it.

I Integrity

The rules are stated, not assumed.

Every brief says what AI use is allowed and what is forbidden. If a use is not listed, it is not allowed. Fair access to permitted tools comes with the rules.

V Visible

Judgement can be seen and defended.

Design tasks so the student's thinking shows: annotated AI outputs, verified sources, a stated rationale, or an oral defence where proportionate.

A Acknowledged

AI use is declared, openly and specifically.

A short statement before the references: the tool, what it was used for, and how the output was checked. Declaring is an act of integrity, not a confession.

Would it survive the viva?

AI can produce an answer; it cannot defend one in the student's place. If a student could not explain and defend the work in conversation, the task may be measuring production rather than understanding, and should be considered for redesign.

Important qualification.

VIVA does not mean every assessment needs a viva voce. It means assessment design should make student judgement visible enough that the work could, where proportionate, be explained and defended.

Grounding.

VIVA is grounded in Oxford's July 2025 principles on AI use in summative assessment: integrity, honesty and transparency; purpose-fit design; and explicit statements of what is permitted, what is forbidden, and how AI use is declared.